

BEYOND THE CREST

Blackwater — Document 05

A Daytime Drama

The Blackwater Syndicate: secretly founded Saturday, September 18, 2010
Blackwater Security International (BSI): founded Monday, October 3, 2011

Founder of both: Marc-Anthony Bullock

WRITERS' ROOM EYES ONLY

Part One: The Blackwater Syndicate

The Blackwater Syndicate is a 100% criminal organization, a true mafia, and the largest, most powerful, most feared, most deadly, and most valuable criminal organization in the world. It is also, strangely, the most beloved. It spares no expense on the communities it protects. Its boss is known inside the organization only as “The Architect.” The Architect is Marc-Anthony Bullock.

Field	Detail
Founded	Saturday, September 18, 2010, Atlanta. Marc-Anthony was 18
Founding members	Marc-Anthony Bullock, Amond Baker, Kane Mitchell
Headquarters	None on paper. The Table meets in rotating locations; the Atlanta seat is a sealed room beneath a BSI training facility
Estimated annual take	\$400–\$600 billion across all operations (FBI estimate: “unknowable”)
Made members	About 9,000 worldwide
Associates	Several hundred thousand, most of whom have never heard the word “Architect”
Territories	43 countries. Every major U.S. city
Street name	“Blackwater,” after the dark stretch of the Chattahoochee below Belmont Crest where Marc used to fish with his great-grandfather
Police name	APD files call it the “ghost network”; the FBI calls it “Organization X”
Calling card	A black river stone, left behind only when the Syndicate wants credit

The Chain of Command

Rank	Name	Public face	Born / Age
The Architect (Boss)	Marc-Anthony Bullock	Actor, President & COO of The Donohue Company, BSI founder	Jan 5, 1992 / 34
Underboss	Amond Baker	Businessman, Marc's best friend	Feb 10, 1992 / 33
Consigliere	Ezekiel “Zeke” Hart	BSI General Counsel; retired Army intelligence colonel and former federal prosecutor	Apr 4, 1958 / 67
Enforcer	Kane Mitchell	Marc's head of personal security	Nov 17, 1990 / 35
Intelligence Chief	Nova Sinclair	BSI Chief Technology Officer	Jan 29, 1996 / 29
The Banker	Cyrus Bell	Private wealth manager	Dec 1, 1979 / 46
Captain, Atlanta	Darnell “Deuce” Whitaker	Nightclub owner	Jun 12, 1987 / 38
Captain, East Coast	Idris Vance	Real estate developer, New York	May 25, 1981 / 44
Captain, West Coast	Tasha “Queenie” Monroe	Film financier, Los Angeles	Oct 3, 1986 / 39
Captain, Africa	Chidi Okafor	Shipping magnate, Lagos	Aug 18, 1979 / 46

Rank	Name	Public face	Born / Age
Captain, Europe	Lorenzo Ferraro	Hotelier, Milan	Jan 14, 1975 / 50

The Table is the ruling council: the Architect, Underboss, Consigliere, Enforcer, Intelligence Chief, Banker, and the five Captains. Only the Table has ever seen the Architect's face. Everyone below them takes orders through the Underboss.

The Seven Laws of Blackwater

Every made member swears these on a black river stone:

- **I.** Children are never touched, never used, never harmed.
- **II.** No powder. Blackwater doesn't sell poison to its own people.
- **III.** No one is ever bought or sold.
- **IV.** The neighborhood eats first.
- **V.** Silence is the price of the stone.
- **VI.** Betrayal is answered once, and completely.
- **VII.** The Architect's family is the Syndicate's family. Touch them and the river rises.

What Blackwater Does

The rackets (always named on screen, never shown as a how-to):

- Underground high-stakes gambling and a global sports book.
- Smuggling of luxury goods, art, and high-end contraband.
- Protection: the Syndicate “taxes” corrupt businesses and landlords who prey on the neighborhoods under its care.
- Loan-sharking to the powerful. Never to the poor.
- Money laundering through shell companies on five continents.
- Political corruption: judges, councilmen, and commissioners on the payroll.
- Intelligence brokering: secrets bought, sold, and buried.
- Fixing: Blackwater makes problems disappear, for a price or for a favor.

Why it's beloved: “The Envelope”

Every Friday, in every city Blackwater controls, envelopes appear: rent paid, medical debt erased, funeral costs covered, HBCU tuition settled. More than \$20 billion a year flows back into Black neighborhoods, and nobody knows where it comes from. Grandmothers on the Westside light candles for “the people from the river.”

History of the Syndicate

2010: Genesis

- Summer 2010: Developer Warren Kessler and a ring of crooked city officials bleed Baker & Sons Contracting dry with rigged permits and a fraudulent lien. Gerald Baker loses nearly everything, and the courts shrug.
- July to September 2010: Marc-Anthony, 18 and a year out of Yale, takes them apart in 90 days using his trust fund, secrets that Amond digs up, and Kane Mitchell's persuasion. Kessler flees the country. Two officials resign. The Bakers get their business back.
- Saturday, September 18, 2010: On the riverbank below Belmont Crest, Marc, Amond, and Kane each pick up a black river stone. The Blackwater Syndicate is born.

2011–2014: Atlanta

- 2011: Ezekiel Hart, Marc's former mock-trial coach and a retired colonel, becomes consigliere.
- Monday, October 3, 2011: BSI is incorporated as the Syndicate's legitimate twin.
- 2012: Nova Sinclair, a 16-year-old hacker who broke into BSI's servers for fun, is recruited instead of prosecuted.
- Saturday, August 24, 2013: **“The Peace of Peachtree.”** Marc brokers an end to a three-crew war in Atlanta, and all three crews swear to Blackwater. Killings in the city's worst neighborhoods fall by half in a year.

2015–2019: National

- 2015: New York (Idris Vance) and Los Angeles (Queenie Monroe) join the Table.
- 2017: Chicago, Houston, Detroit, and Miami fall in line. The Morrow Organization loses Atlanta's ports to Blackwater, and Vincent Morrow's hatred begins.
- 2019: The FBI opens a file on “Organization X.” It has no names.

2020–2025: Global

- 2020: Lagos (Chidi Okafor) and Milan (Lorenzo Ferraro) join. Blackwater becomes the largest criminal organization on Earth.
- 2021: The Syndicate buries Julian Cummings's hit-and-run: the car and the evidence vanish. Marc keeps both, “just in case.” Blackwater quietly pays the victim's daughter, Journee Holloway, through an anonymous scholarship. The same February, a sealed family court order places Lyric with Marc.
- 2024: Terrence “T-Bone” Gaines, an Atlanta lieutenant, starts selling Syndicate secrets.
- Sunday, January 4, 2026, 11:40 PM: T-Bone is murdered under the Paces Ferry Road bridge. Blackwater didn't do it. (Martin Olson did. The audience learns this in Ep #0060.)

Enemies & Threats (Season 1)

Threat	Who	Danger
Law enforcement	Det. Jeremy Jackson; FBI SAC Nadia Brooks	Jeremy's "ghost network" file and the joint task force
The family	Chief Elxa Jackson	Doesn't know. She suspects her father. Figures it out in the finale
Rival mob	Vincent Morrow, the Morrow Organization	Wants Atlanta back. Uses Alvin to reach the World Cup security plans
The cousin	Martin Olson	Knows "the Architect lives on the ridge." Killed T-Bone
The press	Journee Holloway	Digging into 2021 without knowing it leads to Blackwater

Who Knows Marc Is The Architect (as of Jan 5, 2026)

- **The Table:** Amond, Hart, Kane, Nova, Cyrus, and the five Captains.
- **Grace Bullock:** knows, and would hide a body for him.
- **Arianna Cummings:** knows the Syndicate exists and that Marc runs it. Chooses not to know details.
- **Nobody else.** Robert figures it out in Ep #0147. Elxa figures it out in Ep #0170.

Part Two: Blackwater Security International (BSI)

BSI is the legitimate company: a multinational private security and risk-management corporation and one of the largest, most successful, powerful, influential, respected, beloved, feared, and valuable companies in the world. It is 100% legal on paper. It is also the Syndicate's eyes, ears, and armor.

Field	Detail
Legal name	Blackwater Security International, Inc. (private)
Founded	Monday, October 3, 2011, Atlanta, by Marc-Anthony Bullock, 19
Headquarters	BSI Tower, 2011 Northside Parkway NW, Atlanta, GA 30327
Chairman	Marc-Anthony Bullock
CEO	Gen. (Ret.) Calvin Whitmore, the clean public face, who has no knowledge of the Syndicate
General Counsel	Ezekiel Hart
CTO	Nova Sinclair
Valuation	\$1.3 trillion (last private round, November 2025)
Annual revenue	\$118 billion
Employees	410,000 in 71 countries
Clients	Governments, 83 of the Fortune 100, royal families, stadiums, Hollywood, and all of Belmont Crest

Divisions

- **BSI Executive Protection:** bodyguards for heads of state and superstars.
- **BSI Cyber:** cybersecurity and threat intelligence.
- **BSI Crisis Response:** kidnap and ransom, evacuations, disaster response.
- **BSI Events:** security for the Olympics, the Super Bowl, and the **2026 FIFA World Cup matches in Atlanta** (Season 1, Eps #0111–#0134).
- **BSI Maritime:** port and shipping security, which also happens to cover Blackwater's smuggling routes.
- **BSI Risk:** corporate investigations and political risk consulting.

BSI Ownership

Owner	Stake	Value
Marc-Anthony Bullock	58%	\$754B
Management & employees	20%	\$260B
The Donohue Company (strategic stake, 2012)	12%	\$156B

Owner	Stake	Value
Institutional private investors	10%	\$130B
TOTAL	100%	\$1.3T

How the Syndicate hides inside BSI

- BSI's security contracts give Blackwater access to ports, stadiums, and government buildings.
- BSI Cyber monitors every threat to the Syndicate, including police databases.
- The name is the danger: Jeremy Jackson finds “Blackwater” in T-Bone's phone and starts looking at BSI (Eps #0036, #0066, #0109).
- Publicly, Marc says BSI was named after the black water of the Chattahoochee where his great-grandfather taught him to fish. That part is true.

IN THE ARCHITECT'S OWN WORDS

MARC-ANTHONY
 (to the Table, gentle)
 We're not the good guys. Let's never lie about
 that. We're just the guys who make sure the bad
 ones are scared of something.